

SECOND MILE LEADERSHIP

“Serve Without Limits”

TEXT: *“If a soldier demands that you carry his gear for a mile, carry it two miles.”*

Matthew 5:41 (NLT)

INTRO: In Jesus’ day, Roman soldiers had the authority to force civilians to carry their loads for one mile. The Jews held to the letter of the law on this. They measured the mile in steps and set the burden down at exactly one mile irrespective of their surroundings.

(Approximately 1,760 steps)

Jesus’ was saying, *“Give people more than they have the right to demand.”*

When we love without limits, we are like God.

SESSION 1A – IT’S NOT ABOUT YOU

As Americans, we find ourselves in the middle of a capitalist nation where people are free to pursue a life of their choosing, be rewarded for hard work, and have things they have earned.

And there’s nothing wrong with any of that... Except when those ideas and attitudes spill over into the Kingdom of God... And we expect His Kingdom to have the same philosophies and attitudes as the USA. It doesn’t and it’s not supposed to.

In America, the individual is king! His preferences and pursuits are the highest form of reality. In America the “I” is the idol. We have:

- The iPad...
- The iMac...
- The iPod...

- The iPhone...
- Self Magazine...

We are used to and conditioned to this. It is part of a free market and competition and it's a good thing! However, when we bring this philosophy into the church and expect it to operate the same way, the consequences are devastating!

We choose churches based on what they have to offer. We stay as long as they cater to our preferences. We stay as long as we like the music, temperature, messages, people, parking, presentation and expectations. When those are not met, or those get uncomfortable to us, we leave.

Americans have made the church into a corporation and we have moved ourselves from members with obligations to shareholders with

rights. We have exchanged contributing for consuming. We act like we are customers and we are always right. We have made the church about ... ME.

I have bad news tonight! My opening message for those who would be Second Mile Leaders is this:

- It's not about you!
- Jesus never called the individual to elevate himself. Instead He called us to humble ourselves.

He taught us to take the lowest seat at the table. He said, "*The greatest would be servant of all.*" He said, "*The first shall be last and the last first.*" He modeled this in the garden of Gethsemane when he begged God for another way and then chose death on the cross because there was no other way.

In short, Jesus told and showed us there is something more important than the individual.

It's not about YOU!

DEATH TO THE DISCIPLE

Luke 9:23 *“If any of you wants to be my follower, you must turn from your selfish ways, take up your cross daily, and follow me. **24** If you try to hang on to your life, you will lose it. But if you give up your life for my sake, you will save it. **25** And what do you benefit if you gain the whole world but are yourself lost or destroyed?”*

I think that somewhere along the way, we missed what is radical about our faith and replaced it with what is comfortable. We are settling for a Christianity that revolves around

catering to ourselves when the central message of Christianity is actually about abandoning ourselves.

A true disciple is one who realizes that they are in this world for God's purpose and not their own.

Let's take a look at Luke nine:

- Jesus sent the twelve out...
- He fed five thousand...
- Peter declared Jesus to be the Son of God...
- Jesus was transfigured on the Mt. of Olives...
- A demon-possessed boy was delivered...

The crowd had witnessed all of this and three separate people volunteered to follow Jesus.

Look at their offers and His response to their offers:

- *“I will follow you but I don’t want to leave my house...” “Foxes have holes and birds have nests but the Son of God has no place to lay His head.”*
- *“I will follow you but I first need to bury my father...” “Let the dead bury the dead.”*
- *“I will follow you but I must arrange my business affairs...” “No one having put his hand to the plough and looks back is fit for the Kingdom”*

As far as we can tell from this scripture, Jesus talked all three of these guys out of following Him. This gives us a picture of ourselves: Many of us want the benefit of Christ without sacrifice, but often Jesus calls us to the sacrifice without the benefit.

I may very well talk you out of being a Second Mile Leader as we move through this material. If I am able to talk you out of it, you weren't going to make it over the long haul anyway! Second Mile Leadership is not for everyone! If we are to be Second Mile Leaders, we have to understand Jesus is calling us into a mission that is bigger than us. Jesus is saying: It's not about you!

In a world that prizes promoting oneself, they were offering to follow a teacher who told them to go crucify themselves. And history tells us the result - almost all of them would lose their lives because they responded to his invitation.

Jesus calls us to his cause intending to have us to surrender our own!

PRACTICAL APPLICATION

- The church exists for those who are unsaved...
- Second Mile Leaders are called to create opportunities and environments to connect others to Jesus...
- You are called to serve, not to be served...
- If you're being served on the weekend, you're not yet a Second Mile Leader...

If you're going to be a Second Mile Leader, you have to stop looking at what the church can do to benefit you and start looking for what you can do to benefit the church!

- Stop with the entitlement...
- Stop the whining...
- Get humble...
- Be thankful...
- Refuse to be part of the problem...

- Be part of the solution...

Here is how a Second Mile Leader should view weekend services:

- I'm here not for me - I'm here to serve...
- If I get served, great – If not, great...
- I'm not coming to be fed - I'm coming to feed others...
- I'm not coming to get prayer - I'm coming to pray for people... (Hand out altar worker books and students guides)
- I'm not coming to participate - I'm coming to facilitate...
- I'm not going to sit - I'm going to serve...

Life changing truths:

- I'm here to lead, not to be led...
- The Sunday morning message is for others, not for me... (Therefore if I need to serve elsewhere that is not a problem)

- Sunday morning is not my primary worship time... (Therefore if I am needed elsewhere it is not an issue – I have six other day's to worship)
- My first priority on Sunday is no longer me but serving others...
- I am willing to serve where I'm needed, not just where I'm gifted....
- I own the vision and will do whatever is necessary to make it happen...
- I can talk with my friends later. The time before and after service is my chance to connect with people... (I will come early and stay late – EVERY TIME)

In short, as a Second Mile Leader I must exemplify the following attitude:

- I will serve wherever I am needed...
- I will make it easy for new people...
- I will park further away...

- I greet everyone, but will be careful to pay special attention to new people...
- I will help park cars if necessary...
- I will show new people around...
- I am responsible for others...
- I will host a life group...

CONCLUSION:

To be a Second Mile Leader you must unlearn the American way. You must adopt this attitude first: It's not about me.

SECOND MILE LEADERSHIP SESSION 1B WHAT IS THE CHURCH?

Questions:

- Where is CT Church Houston located?
(9701 Almeda Genoa Road)

- How would you describe it if you were giving directions? (Between 45 & Blackhawk – Across from the post office)

Those were trick questions, because that's not where the church is. The building or physical address is not the church. The church is not a place. The church is people.

You cannot go to church because you are the church!

Matthew 16:13-18 *“When Jesus came to the region of Caesarea Philippi, he asked his disciples, “Who do people say that the Son of Man is?” 14 “Well,” they replied, “some say John the Baptist, some say Elijah, and others say Jeremiah or one of the other prophets.” 15 Then he asked them, “But who do you say I am?” 16 Simon Peter answered, “You are the Messiah, the Son of the living God.” 17 Jesus*

replied, “You are blessed, Simon son of John, because my Father in heaven has revealed this to you. You did not learn this from any human being. 18 Now I say to you that you are Peter (which means ‘rock’), and upon this rock I will build my church, and all the powers of hell will not conquer it.”

Jesus said to Peter... *“I will build my church!”*
Except that’s not what he said! Jesus did not say, *“I will build my church.”*

Jesus said, *“Upon this rock I will build my ekklesia.”*

King James translators mistranslated this word in the Greek. The word that you and I are familiar with is the word church.

This word comes from the Old English and German word kirshe. (Pronounced keer-shu)
The word, church has an origin that is not ekklesia. The wrong word was used. They substituted an entirely different Greek word.

Eventually, though, "*church*" came to replace "*ekklésia*" by popular acceptance. This is bad, but why?

THE CORRECT MEANING OF "EKKLESIA"

If we misunderstand what Jesus said, then we will be working our entire lives to do the wrong thing! We will be dedicated to Jesus, but still be in error.

To put it this way, if we want to help Jesus build the Church he said he intended to build, we

really should have a look at the blueprints before we start construction!

So, let's look at the word Jesus used:
The word, "ekklésia" is the greek word used when your bible reads "church." This Greek word appears in this grammatical form 114 times in the bible.

In every instance, except three, it is wrongly translated as "church" in the King James Version.

What, then, did the writers of the New Testament mean when they used the word "ekklésia" to describe a Christian body of people? We can assume that they intended to convey the original Greek meaning of the word:

Ekklesia = a body of Christians called out of the Roman and Judean system to come together into a separate civil community.

Ekklesia meant a politically autonomous body of Christians under no king but Jesus. This was the powerful organism that Jesus left here on earth and empowered once the Holy Spirit was given. It was so pure, so radical, that it literally turned the world upside down!

This is a far cry from the organization that we see and have now. What we have now is one of cold brick and mortar that bears the name church or house of the lord. And, since we are confused in the translation, we assume that what we see is what Jesus intended.

The ekklésias we read about in the New Testament were independent civil bodies of Christians. They were a body, not a building.

Let's take a quick walk through church history, starting with Jesus:

- Israel had the tabernacle. Solomon built the temple. People went to worship.
- When the Holy Spirit Came, they were assembled in a house.
- While it is true that Jesus and the disciples did attend the temple the fact is that they also met publicly and from house to house.
- In the New Testament the emphasis changed from a place to a people!
- Constantine gave Christians a temple. They called it a church. Although this seemed like a great thing, because of what they allowed it to become, it was a bad thing. Why? Because they gave up their personal

responsibility and hid the church behind the walls of a building.

- Because they came to the point that they viewed the building as the church, they hid behind its walls rather than going into all the world as they had been commanded. They adopted a come and see philosophy rather than a go and tell philosophy.
- That philosophy became the death rattle to the ekklesia of God. Anytime a church adopts this philosophy it is writing its obituary in the sand! Because of this philosophy, the Body of Christ, which had survived extreme persecution and still grown exponentially, was stripped of its power. They established clergy and laity. They printed the bible in Latin instead of a common language. Only those who were well educated could read the word of God. The only way then for the people to get the

Word was to go to the Church. This created a self-perpetuating business model for the “church.”

In this modern era of the church we must guard against:

- Seeing the building rather than people as the church...
- Creating holy places instead of holy people...
- Believing inviting people to church is evangelism rather than taking the message to them...

Seeing the church as a building allows us to be one thing at home while another at church. This means I need to act right when I come to the House of the Lord. I need to act proper, holy, dress in my Sunday best. But once I leave, I can do whatever I want, because God stays here.

We are the temple of the Holy Spirit. Second Mile Leaders live the same at home as they do at the “church”. There should be no difference between how we act at “church” and how we act at home.

People are offended at the thought of secular music in the church yet they listen to it at home. It’s either right or wrong. There isn’t really secular and Christian, there is wholesome and unwholesome... Philippians 4:8 ***“Fix your thoughts on what is true, and honorable, and right, and pure, and lovely, and admirable. Think about things that are excellent and worthy of praise.”***

In 1517, Martin Luther raised his 95 objections. He formed the protestant movement we have today. Luther restored the word to the believer,

but did not do away with the liturgy and the building.

The translators used church instead of assembly or body.

So we are still left with the impression that a building is the holy place - when the holy place is in our hearts!

The reformation of Luther restored the word of God to the believer. In the reformation of the last day God wants to restore the work of God to the believer.

What does this mean?

You and I are going to work together to fulfill the great commission and we're going to do it according to the pattern of the New Testament:

- We are going to meet in a building with other believers...
- We are going to meet here for training...
- We are going to meet from house to house...
- We are going to meet at your place and my place...

Beginning here and now we are going to be disciplers. We are all going to lead ministry in our homes! My goal, with your help, is to put a CT Houston campus in every one of your homes!

I'm calling you to stop going to church and start being the church.

SECOND MILE LEADERSHIP
SESSION 2A
EVERY BELIEVER A MINISTER

Every soldier has a duty to perform his role. It is an obligation. It is dishonorable to choose not to fulfill your duty and you can be brought up on charges regarding this and, in some instances, you can even be executed.

But imagine if you will, an army that didn't realize its duty. If they didn't, when the call to war was given, they would stay right where they are and never move. Why? Because they are lazy? Because they are fearful? No! Because they are unaware! They don't know it is their role.

In many cases the word go in the Great Commission has been replaced with the word come.

Think about the army again - because believers have stopped realizing the great commission is

our mission, we have gone off active duty and forgot our duty altogether. What a brilliant move of Satan!

Tragically, the gifts of the whole body have been merged into one person – The Pastor. Everyone else in the church is now merely an ordinary believer who holds a secular job where they specialize in non-spiritual activities such as:

- Bankers...
- Lawyers...
- Doctors...
- Teachers...
- Carpenters...
- Factory workers...

So, in effect, what ought to be accomplished in an ordinary, decentralized, non-professional

manner by all church members working together, would instead be accomplished by a single, full-time professional - The Pastor.

Rather than contributing their part to edify the church, the laity now goes to church as passive receivers to be edified. Rather than actively spending the time and energy to exercise their gift for the good of the body, they sit back and let the pastor run the show. (As long as he runs the show the way they think he should. Because, even though they don't know how to do his job, they know how he should do his job.)

You and I have inherited that mindset because that's the church we came from: First the Roman Catholic Church, then the Anglican Church, then the Methodist Church, then the Pentecostal Church. We've inherited our

methods of leading and governing the church from those ideas.

The result is a crippled ekklesia! Our system has gutted the army of God and left it without anything other than captains and generals. How effective do you think we'll be?

Now, let's look at the intention of God's plan ...

1 Peter 2:9 (NKJV) “*But you are a chosen generation, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, His own special people, that you may proclaim the praises of Him who called you out of darkness into His marvelous light.*” The people mentioned here are not the professional ministers; they are the lay members of the church! It is you!

By definition the word laity means ordinary people as distinct from the professionals or experts! (Talk about the difference in results if the pastor's fingerprint has to be on everything as opposed to delegation... authorization... and a church functioning as a body)

If this idea were fully embraced it would unleash an army of warriors on the world the likes of which the world has not seen since the First Century!

Satan can't afford for you and I to understand the call of God on our lives. If we ever do, we will be unstoppable!

Every believer is a minister!

Let's see what else First Peter says in this verse:

1 Peter 2:9 (NKJV) *“But you are a chosen generation, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, His own special people, that you may proclaim the praises of Him who called you out of darkness into His marvelous light.”*

- Chosen... Means select and is reminiscent of ekklesia. Picked out!
- Royal... Means a body of kings. You are to serve as kings! A king is about provision!
- Priesthood... Means to serve as a priest. A priest is about vision!
- Proclaim... Means announce or speak out!

So you and I are Kings – We are the designated officials of the kingdom of God, therefore we are duly authorized to do Kingdom business!

Jesus deputized us in Matthew 28 *“All authority is given to me... Therefore go...”* What He is saying is that *“I am authorizing you!” “You*

are my representatives.” Why is it that while we are a royal people that we act like peasants?

We are giants who think we are grasshoppers!

(An elephant is trained while he is young to stay within a certain radius by being tethered to a stake driven in the ground... When he weighs 4,000 pounds he could easily pull the stake up but he doesn't know he can!)

Satan is working overtime to keep you and I convinced that we are incapable of fulfilling the great commission. He tells us it is not our job, the pastor is supposed to grow the church! (The last time I checked shepherds don't beget sheep – Sheep beget sheep! Besides that, if a shepherd begets sheep they will be a little strange looking!)

We are the kings and priests and evangelism is the responsibility of each and every one of us!

The reason you are here is that Susan and I are determined to invest in a group of people that we believe can actually get it! Not just that you will get it, that you will actually go do it! We are going to hold you accountable for what you do with what you learn here.

The Levites in the Old Testament could walk into the holy place but only the High Priest could go into the Holy of Holies. At the death of Jesus the curtain in the temple that separated the Holy place from the Holy of Holies was ripped in half! Why?

- To let all of us in... (We have access – All of us!)
- To let God out... (He is everywhere! Not just at the building we call the church!)

If you and I ever figure out who we are, what we have access to, and what is available to us, we will revolutionize the world.

YOU ARE A KING...

YOU ARE A PRIEST...

YOU ARE CALLED TO HIS PURPOSE...

YOU ARE A MINISTER...

SECOND MILE LEADERSHIP

SESSION 2B

IT'S UP TO ME

As a pastor, it's not my job to do the ministry; it's my job to train you to do the ministry. If we don't operate in the paradigm that every believer is a minister, the job won't get done. If we don't make disciples, no one else will! There is no one else coming – We are it!

Everyone say this: It's my job.

God in his omnipotence has chosen to limit himself. He has relegated the outcome of this world to a group of people who must choose to have His kingdom come and His will be done.

There is no other solution, no other way. God is waiting on us to fulfill the great commission. No one else is coming!

As the key leaders in the church, we must ask ourselves the following questions and be honest with ourselves, the leadership of the church, and most importantly with God in our answers!

- Whose job is it to meet new people on the weekend?
- Whose job is it to disciple people?
- Whose job is it to witness to people?

- Whose job is it to set up for events?
- Whose job is it to make sure people are being called when they miss church?
- Whose job is it to visit people in the hospital?
- Whose job is it to pray with people?
- Whose job is it to organize events?
- Whose job is it to work the nursery?
- Whose job is it to counsel people?
- Whose job is it to visit the elderly?
- Whose job is it to go get new people connected?
- Whose job is it to go coordinate volunteers?

Harry Truman had a sign on his desk that said, “*The Buck Stops Here.*” This saying comes say’s I take responsibility when things do not go well. It is saying that I will do what no one else will. I will not have to be asked, I will volunteer

to step into the crosshairs of controversy and lead the situation to a successful conclusion. this says I will take responsibility for running with the vision! In so doing, if I get out of bounds I am ok with being reigned in! (I would much rather work with someone that I have to reign in than someone I have to kick start)

The reason we are leading this group is because we are looking for some people who will come alongside us and say “*Let’s do it! Let’s run with the vision! You can count on me to no matter what.*” Please don’t say you are in and then I have to find out where you are next Sunday!

I’m looking for a group of people to say, “*I’m not sitting back and waiting for someone else to take care of it. I’ll do it!*” I’m looking for some people to say, “*It’s my job! No one else is coming. I’ll handle it!*”

Relate the story of Good Samaritan... Luke
10:25-37

The man wanted to know whom his neighbor was, but Jesus wanted him to be a neighbor.

Here is the heart that Jesus was confronting with this man - he was looking for a way out, not a way in! He wanted to be excused from responsibility rather than shoulder responsibility.

The difference an employee and a business owner is this - The employee does the bare-minimum, check the box and go home. The employer does whatever it takes to get the job done.

Which are you? You're supposed to be Second Mile Leaders. As second mile leaders I want to ask you the following questions:

- Do you cut out as soon as possible or do you hang around to see what you can do?
- Do you come in right as service is starting or do you arrive early to see if there is something you can do?
- Do you leave as soon as the service is over or do you linger, hoping to be useful?
- Are you seeing and seizing opportunities to witness or are you blowing past them in your hurry to nowhere?
- Are you inviting people to church services and life group or are you just showing up and soaking up the goodies?
- Do you own the cause of Christ, or are you just in it for the benefits it produces?
- Are you more concerned with your rights or your responsibilities?

Let's remember we are enlisted men and women. To fail to fulfill our duty is desertion worthy of court martial, prison, or even death (This usually results in someone else's death — Usually someone who does not know Jesus).

Let's remember we are authorized and empowered to fight the enemy on behalf of those dying in their sins. If we don't engage, their blood is on our hands.

Isaiah 6:1-8 (NLT) *“It was in the year King Uzziah died that I saw the Lord. He was sitting on a lofty throne, and the train of his robe filled the Temple. 2 Attending him were mighty seraphim, each having six wings. With two wings they covered their faces, with two they covered their feet, and with two they flew. 3 They were calling out to each other, “Holy,*

*holy, holy is the LORD of Heaven's Armies!
The whole earth is filled with his glory!" 4
Their voices shook the Temple to its
foundations, and the entire building was filled
with smoke. 5 Then I said, "It's all over! I am
doomed, for I am a sinful man. I have filthy
lips, and I live among a people with filthy lips.
Yet I have seen the King, the LORD of
Heaven's Armies." 6 Then one of the seraphim
flew to me with a burning coal he had taken
from the altar with a pair of tongs. 7He
touched my lips with it and said, "See, this coal
has touched your lips. Now your guilt is
removed, and your sins are forgiven." 8 Then I
heard the Lord asking, "Whom should I send
as a messenger to this people? Who will go for
us?" I said, "Here I am. Send me."*

- Who in this room is willing to join Isaiah in saying *"Here I am pastor, send me!"*

- Who is it that is ready for God to say, “Go?”
- Who has already pre-decided that they will do whatever God asks no matter what he asks? Whether it is cleaning toilets, doing administration, preaching, witnessing, hosting, calling, praying..
- Who is ready to say, *“I’ll do it God! Send me! No one else is coming. I’m not waiting for anyone else. It’s my job!”*

Assignment: You are to meet 3 new people this week and be prepared to report their names and something about them next week. You are to have coffee with one of them.

SECOND MILE LEADERSHIP
SESSION 3A
MULTIPLY MINISTRY

Last week I made assignments based on the heart that we needed to realize. I asked each of you to meet three new people this weekend. How many of you did that? Tell me some of those stories. Tell me about the people and what God did.

How many of you scheduled coffee?

We talked last week about how all the gifts being concentrated around a single individual greatly limits or completely stops the work of God in the world.

Why is this so important for us to understand? Because again, **when the work of God is concentrated around a single individual, then it is minimized. This relegates the work of God to operate with minimal impact.** Those who are

professional ministers carry a load they were never called to carry.

Look with me at Acts 6:1-8... (Read this)

- The Apostles were doing all the work...
- The people were suffering from lack of attention...
- A significant issue developed from this dysfunction... (Jews against the Greeks)
- The Apostles had them to choose seven men to oversee this work...
- The seven had to pass the compatibility test...
- When they properly served as a body the word of God spread and many people were added to the faith...

The seven that were chosen were not a ministry in and of themselves; they were an extension of the ministry of the Apostles:

- Stephen performed signs and wonders...
- Stephen lost his life serving...
- Phillip preached a revival in Samaria...
- He led a man to the Lord and baptized him in the Ethiopian desert...

In the First Century Church when the crisis developed the Apostles said:

- If we take this responsibility on the body will suffer...
- If we fulfill this responsibility we will not have time to pray and prepare to teach and preach...
- We will delegate and authorize others to care for this responsibility...
- Second Mile Leaders must take care of these responsibilities...

The Apostles made sure the responsibility was discharged but they did so in the most efficient

way possible. They empowered others to do what needed to be done. NOTICE: They did not say the job is beneath us! This is important for us to understand and remember, no responsibility in the Kingdom is ever beneath us!

The First Century Church had a need in their body and they enabled those with the right calling to do the right job. By stepping up to the responsibility the seven deacons enabled the Apostles to focus on what only they could do, seek vision and communicate the Word. Are you enabling those with the right calling to do the right job? Or are you sitting back and receiving in each weekend without contributing?

What does it mean to function as a body?

- What if the whole body were a foot?

- What if the whole body were an eye?
- What if the whole body were a liver?

Here is a life changing truth: We are only effective when we are connected and running in our lane.

God has put us together for a purpose. That purpose is to function as a body! Our western mind leads us to demand our individuality. We are not individuals we are individual members!

In the New Testament we are called the body of Christ. We are also told that each *“joint”*, specific part, makes its contribution to the whole. So how does this work? We live in an American church that is quadriplegic. It doesn't have arms or legs and it has very little heart. So far as fulfilling its original purpose it's barely alive. It is on life support! Jesus is the head but

tragically, He doesn't have a body. The church is not functioning in an efficient manner; in fact, it is very ineffective overall. If you take transfer growth off the table, the American church is in decline and has been for a few decades.

We all have a part to play in the body.

A body that is not functioning properly cannot serve its purpose and can be a heavy burden to its leaders.

Look at how Moses handles a similar situation: [Exodus 18:9-24](#) (NLT) *“Moses’ father-in-law, Jethro, the priest of Midian, heard about everything God had done for Moses and his people, the Israelites. He heard especially about how the Lord had rescued them from Egypt. 10 “Praise the Lord,” Jethro said, “for he has rescued you from the Egyptians and*

from Pharaoh. Yes, he has rescued Israel from the powerful hand of Egypt! 11 I know now that the Lord is greater than all other gods, because he rescued his people from the oppression of the proud Egyptians.” 13 The next day, Moses took his seat to hear the people’s disputes against each other. They waited before him from morning till evening. 14 When Moses’ father-in-law saw all that Moses was doing for the people, he asked, “What are you really accomplishing here? Why are you trying to do all this alone while everyone stands around you from morning till evening?” 15 Moses replied, “Because the people come to me to get a ruling from God. 16 When a dispute arises, they come to me, and I am the one who settles the case between the quarreling parties. I inform the people of God’s decrees and give them his instructions.”

17 “This is not good!” Moses’ father-in-law exclaimed. 18 “You’re going to wear yourself out—and the people, too. This job is too heavy a burden for you to handle all by yourself. 19 Now listen to me, and let me give you a word of advice, and may God be with you. You should continue to be the people’s representative before God, bringing their disputes to him. 20 Teach them God’s decrees, and give them his instructions. Show them how to conduct their lives. 21 But select from all the people some capable, honest men who fear God and hate bribes. Appoint them as leaders over groups of one thousand, one hundred, fifty, and ten. 22 They should always be available to solve the people’s common disputes, but have them bring the major cases to you. Let the leaders decide the smaller matters themselves. They will help you carry the load, making the task easier for you. 23 If you follow this advice, and

if God commands you to do so, then you will be able to endure the pressures, and all these people will go home in peace.” 24 Moses listened to his father-in-law’s advice and followed his suggestions.”

Moses was the elevated leader so everyone wanted to hear from him. this follows the model of the professional clergy doing all the work. What God and Jethro were trying to accomplish was to institute a more broad-based model where everyone becomes involved. In this model Second Mile Leaders are indispensable.

In Exodus eighteen, God put the work in the hands of the leaders to show that not everything needed to have Moses fingerprints on it.

When the church has the view that only the Pastor can hear from God for them, the capacity

of that church is limited to the capacity of the pastor. A single person can only effectively lead a small number of people.

(Dunbar's Number)

Based on the capacity of our brain we can only maintain up to 150 relationships. This number can be higher or lower based on the person, their social networks, etc. If this is true, in the model of the Pastor doing everything the church will always be 200 people or less.

Eight reasons (Carey Nieuwhof) churches stay small:

- The pastor is the primary caregiver... This model won't scale. If you're good you can grow to 200 before you start to disappoint people or burn out.
- The leader lacks a strategy... Mission, vision is the what. Strategy is the how. The

mission and vision must reside in every member and every member must be running with the strategy.

- True leaders aren't leading... People hold positions of leadership, but aren't leading. In this scenario we must release people with titles who aren't advancing the mission and hand the job over to real leaders. It is vitally important to get the right people on the bus but even more important to get the right people in the right seat.
- Volunteers are under-empowered... We must empower volunteers around an aligned strategy. That is what this training is about.
- Governance team micromanages... (Board that would not allow me to spend more than \$100 without Board approval) Leaders must empower and step away. That is exactly what we plan to do with those who choose to become Second Mile Leaders.

- Too many meetings... Effective leaders only meet on purpose for the future.
- Too many events and programs that lead nowhere... Ineffective churches are often very busy churches. Remember, good is the enemy of great.
- The Pastor suffers from a desire to please everyone... As a parent we have to learn not to do what our kids want to do (congregants), we do what's good for them.

I am looking to put what is in my heart into a group of people who will carry the fire and burning desire of this vision. As Second Mile Leaders, I'll teach you what I want but I want you to follow that vision, not your own vision. I will encourage and correct you as we go, but I want people who are capable and honest. I am looking for owners not renters.

SECOND MILE LEADERSHIP

SESSION 3B

RENTERS OR OWNERS

(House we rented in Malvern to a doctor)

Renters never take care of a house the same as the owners do. People treat rental cars different than their own!

Renters have rights while owners have responsibilities. Renters expect you to come and fix the air conditioner, an owner steps to the responsibility and actually pays the invoice.

Renters want someone to come fix the roof if it leaks. They want you to come and fix the garage door opener, the dishwasher, the stove, the sink if it is clogged or leaking. These things are the problem of the renter but they are the

responsibility of the owner. Renters have an entitlement mentality with regard to the property but owners take responsibility to have everything in working condition.

Owners must take responsibility for any and all issues; they have no one else coming to fix the problems. The responsibility for the property falls on their shoulders. They have to pay for the fixes or do it themselves.

When you are an owner rather than a renter all problems roll uphill. Like we talked about last week, the buck stops here.

Renters find problems, owners fix problems.

So, I will ask you today: Are you a renter of this vision or are you an owner?

- When you hear of a problem in the church, is your first reaction to tell someone else or to fix it yourself?
- When we have an outreach do you show up or do you feel as if you have more important things to do?
- If you show up do you show up early and stay late?
- If you are assigned a responsibility can your leader check it off of their list or do they have to constantly follow up to make sure it doesn't fall through the cracks?
- When I announce that something is a bringing event do you bring people or do you even show up yourself?

See, this is the difference between a renter and an owner. More importantly, it is the difference between an attendee and a Second Mile Leader.

If you are a renter you cannot be a Second Mile Leader. I do not need another group of people to babysit. I need people who can help lead to a new level. If you are an owner, you have the capacity to be a Second Mile Leader. The question then becomes, are you willing to reprioritize your life to do what it takes to be a Second Mile Leader at CT Church?

When you are a Second Mile Leader it is never about you! Say this with me – IT'S NOT ABOUT ME!

So, I want to talk to you about [how to move from a renter to an owner](#).

- [Ask to hear the vision...](#) Disciple – Empower – Serve (Explain each)
- [Get close enough to the leaders to hear their heart...](#) It is not my responsibility to find time to mentor you – It is your responsibility

to figure out how to get some of my time without killing my schedule – Britt Brooks – Look where he’s at now.

- Learn to see what the leader sees... Stop seeing things the way you have always seen them – Try to see what the leader sees – Ask yourself “*Why would he/she handle this the way they do?*” Thomas Hale said, “*Unless you can see what I see, I don't need you. Until you see what I see and you're working toward the vision, I have no use for you.*”
- Make demands on the experience of the leader... The way you make a demand on the experience of the leader is to tell them what you are dealing with and how you plan to handle it, and ask, “*How would you handle this?*” Don’t get offended when they tell you they would do something differently and do it their way, not yours!

- Rearrange your life so that you can maximize your contribution to the vision...
Fulfilling a vision will cost you something. If you are unwilling to pay the price, you cannot be a Second Mile Leader.
- Focus on the impact of the vision...
(Fulfilling a vision is costly – Exhausting – and at times can be discouraging! The only way to remain an upbeat leader over the long haul is to focus on the impact the vision is having. Food fairs – Health fairs – Project Hope 100 staff and students – Marriages being put back together through Live Well Family Services – People finally experiencing freedom through Freedom Weekends – Ministers and churches being turned around through Empowerment Conference)

Sometimes you have to act your way into feeling rather than feeling your way into acting.

Second Mile Leaders own the vision rather than renting it from the pastor. They have decided to do whatever, whenever, wherever in order to fulfill the vision.

Second Mile leaders are always a yes rather than a no!

I want to close with a scriptural example of what it looks like to be a Second Mile Leader. As we read through this passage I want you to keep in mind the following things:

- The Philistines had the Israeli's hopelessly outnumbered...
- The Israeli's were spending their time looking for better caves to live in...

- Only two Israeli's owned a sword and that was Jonathan and his father... (His father was nowhere to be found)
- The Philistines occupied the high ground...
- For Jonathan and his armor bearer to attack the Philistines they would have to climb up a mountainside while the enemy looked on...
- Jonathan and his armor bearer put their life on the line to own the vision...

1 Samuel 14:1-13 (NLT) *“One day Jonathan said to his armor bearer, “Come on, let’s go over to where the Philistines have their outpost.” But Jonathan did not tell his father what he was doing. 6 “Let’s go across to the outpost of those pagans,” Jonathan said to his armor bearer. “Perhaps the LORD will help us, for nothing can hinder the LORD. He can win a battle whether he has many warriors or only a few!” 7 “Do what you think is best,” the*

armor bearer replied. “I’m with you completely, whatever you decide.” 8 “All right then,” Jonathan told him. “We will cross over and let them see us. 9 If they say to us, ‘Stay where you are or we’ll kill you,’ then we will stop and not go up to them. 10 But if they say, ‘Come on up and fight,’ then we will go up. That will be the LORD’s sign that he will help us defeat them.” (THIS HAD TO BE THE DUMBEST STRATEGY EVER) 11 When the Philistines saw them coming, they shouted, “Look! The Hebrews are crawling out of their holes!” 12 Then the men from the outpost shouted to Jonathan, “Come on up here, and we’ll teach you a lesson!” “Come on, climb right behind me,” Jonathan said to his armor bearer, “for the LORD will help us defeat them!” 13 So they climbed up using both hands and feet, and the Philistines fell before

Jonathan, and his armor bearer killed those who came behind them.”

Jonathan’s armor bearer owned his leaders vision!

Renters say: That sounds crazy I'm not doing it.
Owners say: That sounds crazy, let's do it!

We are not asking you to follow us because we have it all figured out. We need you to own the vision and help to carry it out. We are looking for people to follow and implement the vision, no matter what that requires of you. No matter the cost, no matter the sacrifice, no matter the position, no matter the job or strategy. We are looking for people who will say:

“Do what you think is best. We are with you heart and soul, whatever you decide.” This is

exactly what a Second Mile Leader say's and does! Are you a Second Mile Leader?

SECOND MILE LEADERSHIP

SESSION 4A

CIRCLES VERSES ROWS

Let's imagine the church in two different paradigms:

- The church with everything centered around a professional - the pastor... A church that meets together one to three times per week to listen passively as someone gives the audience their latest and greatest revelation from God's word, In this paradigm, the pastor gives a monologue while the audience sits quietly and respectfully, as they should, because we cannot have everyone talking in a dialogue with the single individual on the stage. The pastor dispenses revelation. Some

of the people come forward to make a commitment to the topic. This week will be different they say by their presence at the front of the room. The offering buckets are passed. The people leave. They spend the rest of their Sunday and the other six days of their week doing their jobs and working in their homes. Their focus is now on real life.

- **The church where every believer is a minister...** Listen to Paul's instructions This is the church in the Constantinian model. Contrast this with Paul's instructions to the Corinthians. **1 Corinthians 14:26** (ESV)
“What then, brothers? When you come together, each one has a hymn, a lesson, a revelation, a tongue, or an interpretation. Let all things be done for building up.”
Wouldn't it be great to go to a church where every believer gets a chance to teach a lesson? Everyone gets to sing! Everyone

gets to give their testimony! Everyone! I'm sure none of us want to do this, but if we don't we are in direct contradiction to Paul's instruction for New Testament church model!

Could it be that we don't have the right understanding or the right model? Perhaps it is because in 1 Corinthians fourteen, when Paul uses the word church he is not talking about the weekend service as we know it. Because we are conditioned to think of church as the corporate worship service on the weekend, we may miss something that should be very clear to us.

The word church appears no less than ten times in 1 Corinthians fourteen. Every time the word church is used in this chapter it is the word "*Ekklesia*."

While we are thinking the public gathering, Paul is talking about a smaller, more intimate gathering of believers. A gathering in a house – Yep, a life group! The first Century Church started and expanded in houses.

[Acts 2:2](#) (ESV) “*And suddenly there came from heaven a sound like a mighty rushing wind, and it filled the entire house where they were sitting.*”

[Acts 2:42-47](#) (ESV) “*All the believers devoted themselves to the apostles’ teaching, and to fellowship, and to sharing in meals (including the Lord’s Supper), and to prayer. 43 A deep sense of awe came over them all, and the apostles performed many miraculous signs and wonders. 44 And all the believers met together in one place and shared everything they had. 45 They sold their property and possessions*

and shared the money with those in need. 46 They worshiped together at the Temple each day, met in homes for the Lord's Supper, and shared their meals with great joy and generosity — 47 all the while praising God and enjoying the goodwill of all the people. And each day the Lord added to their fellowship those who were being saved.”

[Acts 5:42](#) (ESV) *“And every day, in the temple and from house to house, they did not cease teaching and preaching Jesus as the Christ.”*

[Acts 20:20](#) (ESV) *“How I did not shrink from declaring to you anything that was profitable, and teaching you in public and from house to house.”*

[Romans 16:3-5](#) (ESV) *“Greet Priscilla and Aquila, my fellow workers in Christ Jesus. 4*

They risked their lives for me. Not only I but all the churches of the Gentiles are grateful to them. 5 Greet also the church that meets at their house.”

Romans 16:10-11 (ESV) *“Greet Apelles (App-ell-us), tested and approved in Christ. Greet those who belong to the household of Aristobulus (A-wrist-uh-blus) 11 Greet Herodion (Her-owed-ee-on), my relative. Greet those in the household of Narcissus (Nar-siss-us) who are in the Lord.”*

1 Corinthians 16:19 (ESV) *“The churches of Asia send you greetings. Aquila and Prisca, together with the church in their house, send you hearty greetings in the Lord.”*

Colossians 4:15 (ESV) “*Give my greetings to the brothers at Laodicea, and to Nympha (Nim-fuh) and the church in her house.*”

Philemon 1:2 (ESV) “*And Apphia (App-fee-uh) our sister and Archippus (Arkey-pus) our fellow soldier, and the church in your house.*”

There is nothing wrong with a corporate gathering. In fact, the Scripture says Jesus had a habit of going to the Temple. The problem with the American church is that the corporate gathering has become everything. American Christians are in the bad habit of going to church rather than being the church. Second Mile Leaders continue going to church but actively engaged in being the church the other six days of the week.

The job of Second Mile Leaders is to go beyond being a Christian to making disciples.

Second Mile Leaders know that circles are better than rows.

We attend church on Sunday but normally by the middle of the week most people have little recall of the message or how it is supposed to change their lives. (this is why I always preach in series – I am hammering the truth home – So they can't forget it)

Sadly, for most Christians the weekend service is an opportunity to fulfill their religious responsibility for the week. They have decided that the weekend service was just an emotional moment they had, and they are now off the hook.

This happens at CT Church every single week. Sunday morning is a spark. It is the ignition source for what God wants to do in our lives. However, without attention and follow-up, that spark goes out. What could have been a raging fire is now extinguished. And we wait again until Sunday morning to see if we can get the fire lit once more.

Contrast what we have been doing with the New Testament Church. They went to church but through their meetings in homes, they:

- Prayed...
- Worshiped...
- Taught the Word...
- Partook of the Lords Supper...
- Practiced spiritual gifts...
- Evangelized the lost...
- Baptized new believers...

- Took care of social needs... (Strangers – Orphans – Widows - SOW)

What happens on the weekend is great. I don't minimize it and we shouldn't do away with it. Yet the weekend service in and of itself is very ineffective.

On the weekend, you can be anonymous. You can hide. You don't have to share what God is saying to you or convicting you of. You don't have to shoulder the burden of others. You can slip in and slip out with little or no commitment. You can check the box of church going in your mind without ever coming close to what it means to be a true disciple of Christ. And that's what happens week to week in many churches.

The following things happen when we get people in circles instead of rows:

- We form relationships that we did not have before...
- We confront one another in a spirit of love and honesty...
- We hold each other accountable for our spiritual progress...
- We tend to learn more when we study as a group rather than walking alone... (Iron sharpens iron)
- Inviting becomes more realistic because of the geography...
- More evangelism can happen in circles than in rows...
- More people are discipled in circles than in rows...

I envision a weekend gathering where we are celebrating rather than creating and discipling. Sunday is where we are rejoicing over the reports of what God is doing in and through the

church. (I can't wait to hear the testimonies of what God is doing in your homes – I mean circles!)

The testimonies will come when the mission and DNA of Christ has gotten into you and you've gotten out of your rows and into circles and people are being reached, healed and sent.

SECOND MILE LEADERSHIP
SESSION 4B
WE DON'T GET WHAT WE WANT

Second Mile Leaders don't always get what they want!

In American culture we are conditioned to believe *“It's all about me.”*

When we don't get what we want, we question:

- Is God listening to me?
- Does God know where I am?
- Does God really love me?
- Does God really care for me?
- Is God mad at me?
- What did I do wrong?

When we don't get exactly what we become a martyr. We deal with feelings of:

- Guilt...
- Anger...
- Greed...
- Jealousy...

We believe God owes us. The truth is God doesn't owe us anything. In fact, we are blessed far more than we deserve to be already. God doesn't owe us anything:

- God doesn't owe us an explanation...

- He doesn't owe us good health...
- He doesn't owe us wealth...
- He doesn't owe us long life...
- He doesn't owe us retirement...

God gave us Jesus and that is more than enough.
Second Mile Leaders know: God doesn't owe
me, He owns me!

When we get that one truth embedded in our souls we know God really does love us and He has a plan that is larger than our lives here on earth. He will continue loving us no matter what happens. We can trust Him no matter where His path takes us. We have a loving Father who is free to us just as He wills.

This is the realization that you and I must come to if we are to be used in the Kingdom for the purpose of God.

God owns us. He loves us. He cares for us. He is free to use us whenever, wherever, however He chooses. [1 Corinthians 6:19-20](#) (NLT) ***“Don’t you realize that your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit, who lives in you and was given to you by God? You do not belong to yourself, 20 for God bought you with a high price. So you must honor God with your body.”***

[Romans 12:1](#) (NLT) ***“Therefore I urge you, brethren, by the mercies of God, to present your bodies a living and holy sacrifice, acceptable to God, which is your spiritual service of worship.”***

We don’t belong to ourselves anymore. [As Second Mile Leaders we have chosen to give our lives away.](#) Trust me, as leaders, people will disappoint you, criticize you, hurt you, betray

you, and stab you in the back. But your life doesn't belong to you anyway, does it? (You can't hurt, frustrate, or offend a dead man)

In the fourth chapter of James, the author asks us a question that seems so open ended. It couldn't possibly have just one answer: [James 4:1-3](#) (NLT) **“What is causing the quarrels and fights among you? Don't they come from the evil desires at war within you? 2 You want what you don't have, so you scheme and kill to get it. You are jealous of what others have, but you can't get it, so you fight and wage war to take it away from them. Yet you don't have what you want because you don't ask God for it. 3 And even when you ask, you don't get it because your motives are all wrong—you want only what will give you pleasure.”**

Listen to what James is saying: *We don't get to*
*get what ***we want.****

We sing a song that means a lot to me. *“I give myself away / I give myself away so you can use me. My life is not my own / to you I belong I give myself, I give myself away.”*

We are drawing to a close in the first four weeks of this class. We have laid the foundation for what is to come. And in order for us to be useful as we progress into what God has for us and is calling us into, we must remember this. We are not our own. We were bought with a price. *The worship of a Second Mile Leader is to give their own bodies away.* As a baby Christian you worshipped through your praying and singing, now that you are becoming a leader your worship will be in how completely you give

yourself to His work. We do that through what we do with them.

I hope you will join me as we dive into what it is going to look like to truly and fully give ourselves away.

SECOND MILE LEADERSHIP

SESSION 5A

FOUR C'S

How many of you guys have ever worked on a home improvement project like plumbing where you went to the hardware store twelve times?

Each trip you needed to get a different part that cost \$.25 cents. Trying to get the right part and the right fit is sometimes very difficult. That \$.25 cent part cost you about \$13 in fuel, four extra hours of frustration, and a prayer of repentance for your thoughts and words, right?

Ephesians 4:15-16 (ESV) “*Rather, speaking the truth in love, we are to grow up in every way into him who is the head, into Christ, 16 from whom the whole body, joined and held together*”

by every joint with which it is equipped, when each part is working properly, makes the body grow so that it builds itself up in love.”

Finding our place in the body is very important. Each of us has a place we fit in the body. None of us are the same and that's by design!

It would be interesting to know just exactly how many fittings the gasoline in your car made it through from the earth to your engine in order to power your car to get you here tonight. If any one of those fittings failed the result could be that you wouldn't make it to this class!

Ephesians says that the whole body is to fit together and each part is responsible to do its work. No one can fulfill the work of God without connecting with people who:

- Love you...

- Like you...
- Don't love you...
- Don't like you...

Some people are easy to love but hard to like. When this is the case as leaders our tendency is to act like magnets turned the wrong way. We push away from each other because of our magnetic personalities.

Remember the plumbing job? It is very important to get the right part and the right seal so the job will be complete - without any leaks! It is also very important that oil refineries do not have failed fittings and release deadly chemicals into the air! People's earthly lives are at stake!

When we as the church don't fit together, something more valuable is lost – eternal lives!

We are the conduit that God has decided to filter people through in order that He might do His work in them. If we break apart, people will be lost.

Many people have left the church because of all of this breaking apart - because of fractures in relationships, because of conflict, and because people have not worked to resolve their issues one with another.

As Second Mile Leaders we are not in the business of being right, we are in the business making people right with God.

Sometimes that means you and I are going to have a little friction on our lives. There will be a little tension at the joints from time to time. We're not always going to be able to get to be right. As leaders we will no doubt have to

surrender our rights as we climb the leadership ladder. [Second Mile Leaders know that the higher they go on the ladder of leadership the fewer rights we have.](#)

If the surrendering of rights isn't alright with you, then maybe you're not ready for leadership. As leaders, we can't afford to be offended or offensive. We have to be people that can connect one to another so that God can do what he wants to do through us. We have to connect with people we like and people we may struggle to like. So how do we make sure that we fit together and do our job well?

There are four C's that really define what makes a great team member and leader. If I hire someone, I'm going to want to make sure they have all four of these things with me and with the team. If I'm going to allow a person to lead

people, I expect the same. If you're going to gel with people you need all four C's.

A deficiency or a lack of one of these will surface soon or later if you don't have it. And if you don't have it, it will cause a structural failure in your leadership and those you are connected to. **Four C's of leadership:**

- **Character...** Character is your internal quality. Without character you will break, and in that breaking you will break others. **People with character are reliable** - they cannot be depended on. You can't be excited about a new initiative and then when it gets harder before it gets easier, you decide to bail on the process. If this is you, you have already capped your ability to lead. You are not a person of character. Why? No one can really rely on you. You are like a limb that looks trustworthy, but when you start to put

some weight on it - crack! And that's the sound of your bones hitting the ground. This is what happens to the people in your life if you can't follow through. [A person of character is trustworthy](#). Can people count on you too not only be there for them, but to cover them? Do you celebrate exposing the weaknesses of others? If someone tells you something in confidence, can they count on you to keep it to yourself or are you going to tell others? Can people share their burdens with you and know that you were not going to turn around and stab them in the back and betray their confidence to someone else? [Character means you are a person of integrity](#). Are you who you say you are? Or are you a hypocrite? Is there a discrepancy between what you say you are and what you do? Hypocrisy will take you out of leadership. The difference in failure and

hypocrisy - Failure is acknowledged -
Hypocrisy ignores or covers failure and pretends it doesn't exist. That's called being phony. And people run from phony! There is no place at the Second Mile table for a phony! **Character means you are a quality person.** Do you have a deep reliance on your relationship with God that guides your decisions and actions? Can you be trusted to do what is in the best interest of God, others, and yourself in that order? Or are you in this just for you? Your gifting will only take you as far as your character can sustain you. Character is the first and foremost qualification of a Second Mile Leader. If you are not a person of character, you simply are not able to lead. As a leader, if we are not a person of character, people will figure that out and eventually disconnect from us.

- Competence... Competence is your ability through your knowledge and skill. This is the question of ability, not of trustworthiness. Are you capable of doing what you're supposed to do? If not, are you capable of learning? Do you have the drive to get better at what you're doing? Are you studying what you want to be doing, finding ways to do it better? When you don't know what to do are you willing to ask? Do you have a mentor? A person can be extremely competent to do one thing and completely incompetent in others. Some people couldn't organize their way out of a paper sack, but they're terrific at connecting with people. Are you working to get better? Leaders are lifetime learners. Are you studying what you need to know to lead more effectively? In the church, people want to follow leaders. They do this voluntarily. Many times

incompetent leaders in the church do not get fired. The leader of the church may not fire you but the people fire incompetence by leaving. **As a leader, if you're not competent at what you're doing, others will eventually disconnect from you.** (A leader who had made a huge mess once asked me – “*Are you going to fire me?*” Even though I loved the person dearly my response was, “*If you knew to do this and didn't you are negligent! If you did not know to do this, you are incompetent. Either way I have to fire you.*” Had I not fired this person I would have been just as negligent and incompetent as they were”

- **Culture...** The culture of an organization is its DNA and vision. When we first started this Second Mile Leadership class, some of you probably didn't know some of the things I would present. As we went along, I

was sharing with you what my vision is and what I want this church to look like. Some of you might have had another paradigm in mind. You might have thought of church differently or valued different things. I have been working to adjust that culture in our church. **The culture cannot be adjusted unless and until it is fully implemented in the minds of the Second Mile Leaders.** It may come as a surprise to you, but not everyone is excited about the vision and direction I've set forth. Some families have left based on the culture I'm seeking to establish. I am determined to have a church full of ministers that are actively seeking to reconcile men to God in their daily lives. I'm determined to put a campus in every neighborhood. I'm determined to celebrate on the weekend what is happening as the church is the church on the weekdays. Do

you have the DNA of the organization? We cannot have division and leadership. We cannot have two different directions for the church to go. You must serve under leadership just as I am serving under leadership. If you want to go another direction, then you cannot lead. If they have a different DNA or Culture, they're not going to stick around. The DNA and culture are the systems, philosophies and beliefs of the organization. You can be a part of the weekend gathering without adhering to the Culture and DNA, but you cannot lead without adhering to them.

- Chemistry... Chemistry is that intangible thing that helps you connect with others. Have you ever met people that just had a hard time connecting? Without chemistry, you can't bond! You won't be able to "gel." You won't be able to connect. You'll be like

a magnet turned the wrong way. If you don't have chemistry, people just won't like you. You may be a great person, but just missing that connection. Work on it. Ask others what they think, be humble, make corrections.

As a Second Mile Leader it is essential that you have all four C's. Having all four is important, because one without the other can prove to be a major lid on the life of a leader.

Character + Competence + Culture without Chemistry = Lonely

Character + Culture + Chemistry without Competence = Faulty

Culture + Chemistry + Competence without Character = Deadly

Chemistry + Competence + Character without
Culture = Division

SECOND MILE LEADERSHIP
SESSION 5
ATTITUDE

One of the big goals of these sessions is to help us develop and step into our God given roles as leaders! I want to empower leaders to carry out the work of the ministry.

Leading well begins with what we think and what we say. It starts with the “A” word – The attitude of the leaders. Ephesians 4:21-23 (NLT)

“Since you have heard about Jesus and have learned the truth that comes from him, 22 throw off your old sinful nature and your former way of life, which is corrupted by lust and deception. 23 Instead, let the Spirit renew your thoughts and attitudes. 24 Put on your

new nature, created to be like God—truly righteous and holy.”

We often assume that leadership is all about skills and techniques. In reality, our leadership begins when we possess the right attitude about our circumstances and ourselves.

William James, the father of modern psychology, wrote: *“The greatest discovery of my generation is that humans can alter their lives by altering their attitude of mind.”*

Zig Ziglar said that *“Your attitude, not your aptitude will determine your altitude!”* In the last session, we learned that aptitude (Competence) is extremely important in the life of the leader but attitude is equally important.

Here is why - Attitude (your thought-feelings) determines action and actions determine your

accomplishments. So, think about it! Whatever attitude you operate in pre-determines the outcome!

Henry Ford said, “*Whether a man thinks he can or he can’t, he’s right!*”

In so many situations, the battle is won before the battle has begun. It all has to do with the frame of mind with which we enter the battle. Are we full of faith, hope and optimism? Or are we negative and doubtful of getting results?

This principle was illustrated when Moses sent the twelve spies into the Promised Land in Numbers Chapter 13-14. Joshua and Caleb came back with a positive report. The other ten spies returned with a negative report. Their attitude prevailed, and that generation of people never got to enter the land:

- Joshua and Caleb saw the possibilities the other ten spies saw the problems.
- Joshua and Caleb saw themselves as strong through the Lord. The other ten spies saw themselves as small and weak.

(Grasshoppers)

- Joshua and Caleb were optimistic about the future. The other ten spies were pessimistic about the future.
- Joshua and Caleb encouraged the people to step out in. The other ten spies caused the heart of the people to melt.

In the days ahead, as you begin leading, you're going to be faced with many days of feeling that you can't or don't want to. This attitude will sabotage your leadership before you ever get started.

Conversely, a right attitude can make up for what you may lack in resources. Many leaders in the past have accomplished great things without any resources other than a positive attitude of faith. (The right attitude is your greatest resource)

My attitude toward others is the greatest determining factor of their attitude toward the vision.

Luke 6:38 (NIV) “Give, and it will be given to you. A good measure, pressed down, shaken together and running over, will be poured into your lap. For with the measure you use, it will be measured to you.”

Generally speaking, people are mirrors. They will reflect the attitude of their leader. We must

initiate the attitude we want in return. Leaders must understand this to get results.

- Belief begets belief...
- Trust begets trust...
- Hope begets hope...
- Positivity begets positivity...

If you're negative, always saying how unfaithful people are, how bad people are, always finding fault with others, always speaking death over your ministry, I can guarantee people will not follow you as a leader. And the very attitudes you espouse will become truths.

Try this: Walk into a room with joy and a smile even if you don't feel it and watch people respond. Then, walk into a room grumpy and see what happens.

Attitude can turn problems into blessings.

We can begin dreaming or become discouraged. We can build or blame. We can take action or get angry. We can conquer or concede. Whether the problem becomes a blessing depends on us more than God. He desires to turn all things into blessings. [Romans 8:28](#) (NLT) *“And we know that God causes everything to work together for the good of those who love God and are called according to his purpose for them.”*

Remember, prisoners, oppressed minorities, and those in captivity wrote much of the Bible. The writers rose above their circumstances. [As Second Mile Leaders are we going to allow the circumstances to control our attitudes or are we going to rise above the circumstances to have a good positive attitude? Mark 9:23 \(NIV\)](#)
“Everything is possible to him that believes.”

A shoe salesman was sent to a faraway country, and after a few days, he sent back the message,

“Coming home; nobody wears shoes here.”

Another salesman from the shoe company visited the same country. He wrote back to the home office after a few days: *“Send more shoes! Nobody has them yet over here!”*

(Same situation - Different perspectives)

Think about this in terms of volunteers:

- We don't have enough volunteers...
- Nobody wants to serve here...
- I can't get enough help in my ministry...
- These people are lazy and don't want to serve...

In such a scenario the attitude should be:

Very few people are committed to a ministry here – The potential volunteer base is enormous!

As a Second Mile Leader attitude is our best friend or our worst enemy! Recruiting volunteers through announcements is fruitless – Recruitment is most effective through relationships. There are two reasons that people volunteer:

- They believe in the leader...
- They believe in the vision of the leader...

Luke 6:45 (NIV) “*A good man brings good things out of the good stored up in his heart, and an evil man brings evil things out of the evil stored up in his heart. For the mouth speaks what the heart is full of.*”

Attitudes create momentum - positive or negative. Leaders know this. A poll conducted among business executives listed the most important elements for potential employees:

- 5% availability...

- 5% adaptability...
- 10% ability...
- 10% appearance...
- 70% attitude...

My attitude, not my achievements will determine my happiness. Ecclesiastes 2:11 (NLT) *“But as I looked at everything I had worked so hard to accomplish, it was all so meaningless—like chasing the wind. There was nothing really worthwhile anywhere.”* Ecclesiastes 3:12-13 (NLT) *“So I concluded there is nothing better than to be happy and enjoy ourselves as long as we can.13 And people should eat and drink and enjoy the fruits of their labor, for these are gifts from God.”*

The thoughts in your mind are more important than the things in your life. Too many leaders

think if they could just move to a new place or have different circumstances they would be happy. You know what the problem with this is? When you get there, you're there! *"Everywhere I go, there I am!"* My attitude will change when I to change it. [2 Corinthians 10:5](#) (ESV) ***"We destroy arguments and every lofty opinion raised against the knowledge of God, and take every thought captive to obey Christ."***

"We cannot tailor-make the situations of our life and leadership, but we can tailor-make the attitudes to fit them before they arrive."

[Attitude needs continual adjustment.](#)

[Philippians 4:8](#) (NLT) ***"Finally, brothers and sisters, whatever is true, whatever is noble, whatever is right, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is admirable—if anything is***

excellent or praiseworthy—think about such things.”

Indicators for attitude adjustments:

- I haven't had enough time with God...
- I haven't spent enough time with my family... (In ministry you will NEVER have quantity time – Make it quality time)
- Those closest to me notice a negative change in my attitude...
- My relationship with co-workers becomes strained...
- My view of people becomes increasingly negative....
- My perspective becomes cynical...

As a leader we must always remember, attitude is contagious! People catch our attitudes like they catch a cold from us - by getting close to us.

Leaders must check bad attitudes at the door, put on their brave face and show up with a great attitude because attitude is infectious! As a Second Mile Leader you don't have the luxury of publicly stating an opposing opinion of the direction on the team or displaying a bad attitude! (I supported Bro. Granberry's vision at HCC when I did not believe it was the thing to do. In fact, I raised millions of dollars and performed thousands of hours of work to accomplish his vision and NO ONE including my wife knew that I did not believe it was the right thing to do)

Notice the devastating consequences the negative attitude of ten spies had upon an entire generation of Israelites: [Numbers 13:31-33](#) ***“But the other men who had explored the land with him disagreed. “We can’t go up against them!”***

They are stronger than we are!” 32 So they spread this bad report about the land among the Israelites: “The land we traveled through and explored will devour anyone who goes to live there. All the people we saw were huge. 33 We even saw giants there, the descendants of Anak. Next to them we felt like grasshoppers, and that’s what they thought, too!”

Numbers 14:1-2, 20-21-22 “Then the whole community began weeping aloud, and they cried all night. 2 Their voices rose in a great chorus of protest against Moses and Aaron. “If only we had died in Egypt, or even here in the wilderness!” they complained. -- 20 Then the LORD said, “I will pardon them as you have requested. 21 But as surely as I live, and as surely as the earth is filled with the LORD’s glory, 22 not one of these people will ever enter that land.”

Don't think for a minute as a leader that your attitude only affects you. We must always remember, that a negative attitude of a leader will cause suffering to the team and everyone under that persons influence.

Attitude Checklist:

- How do I respond when asked to do something new or outside my comfort zone?
- How do I respond when I'm inconvenienced?
- If people hang out with me, will they catch a positive or negative attitude?
- If people hang out with me will they be encouraged or discouraged?
- What is at the root of negative attitudes and how can we combat those?

Discussion questions:

- Have you ever experienced someone on a team or at your job that was missing one of the C's? (Character – Competence – Culture – Chemistry)
- How did that situation affect your workplace or team?
- What do you think could have been done to correct this missing part in this person's life?
- Which of the four C's do you think you struggle with the most? How can we help you do better in that area?
- Why is our attitude so critical in being effective leaders?
- Have you ever had to deal with a leader with a bad attitude? How did that go?
- What areas of your life cause you to struggle with your attitude?

- If people hung out with you, would they catch positive attitudes? Would they be encouraged or discouraged?
- What is at the root of bad attitudes and how can we combat those?

SECOND MILE LEADERSHIP

SESSION 6A

MAKING DISCIPLES

Matthew 28:18-20 *“Jesus came and told his disciples, “I have been given all authority in heaven and on earth. 19 Therefore, go and make disciples of all the nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and the Son and the Holy Spirit. 20 Teach these new disciples to obey all the commands I have given you. And be sure of this: I am with you always, even to the end of the age.”*

Jesus didn't say:

- Preach...
- Witness...
- Follow up...
- Make converts...
- Go to church...

Jesus said make disciples. The definition of discipleship is as follows:

- Helping someone to progressively learn the Word of God...
- Helping someone to become spiritually mature...
- Helping someone to grow from a learner to a true Christ follower...

God gave me a definition of discipleship that changed my life and the way I look at being a leader: *“You haven’t truly made a disciple until you have reached someone, trained them and they have reached someone and are in the process of training them. Then and only then is the process of discipleship complete.”*

In order to make disciples we are going to have to get out of our rows and into circles. **Disciple**

making is best done face-to-face and life-on-life over a long period of time.

It's not until we really get to know someone and experience their struggle that we can really speak to the real issues of their lives. People come forward for prayer on the weekend asking that we pray for their father, spouse, or whatever but what they don't say is:

- I'm bound by porn...
- I'm cheating on my spouse...
- I'm abusing my children...
- I'm living in my car...

We don't find those things out until we get into relationship with them. These relationships have to be life-on-life and long-term, deep interpersonal relationships. They are built on trust and grow over time.

Disciple making is all about people building. An old Chinese proverb says: “If you want one year of prosperity, grow grain. If you want ten years of prosperity, grow trees. If you want one hundred years of prosperity, grow people.”

If you’re going to be a Second Mile Leader, it is going to require being in relationships with people for a long time. This is not a short-term assignment. Second Mile Leaders are not a flash in the pan they are in this for the long haul.

Here’s the discipleship formula:

- Connect...
- Serve...
- Influence...

To disciple people, we must connect with people. We connect with people by demonstrating genuine concern and care - about

them, not you *“People don’t care how much you know until they know how much you care.”*

What is the best way to connect with people?

- Communicate with openness and sincerity – BE REAL! People can smell a phony a mile away.
- Know our audience – When we work with individuals, knowing our audience means learning people’s names, finding out their histories, asking about their dreams.
- Speak about what they care about, not what we care about - Learn to be an active listener! God gave us two ears and one mouth, maybe we should listen twice as much as we talk!
- Practice what we preach - Live our message. People can spot a phony a mile away.
- Go where they are – Remove as many barriers to communication as possible. Try

to be attuned to their culture, background, education, and so on.

- Adapt to them - Don't expect them to adapt to you.
- Sit where they sit. Understand things from their perspective.
- Focus on them – We must get the focus off of ourselves and get it on them.
- Make eye contact - Listen to what they are saying rather than focusing on what you are going to say next.
- Learn their names and their story - Stop talking about us and let them tell us about themselves.
- Be available to them – We must give them our phone numbers - Answer the phone - Call them and pray for them. We can't be a discipler or a Second Mile Leader if we do not want to be inconvenienced.

- Believe in Them – It's one thing to communicate to people because you believe you have something of value to say. It's another to communicate with people because you believe they have value. People's opinions of us have less to do with what they see in us than with what we can help them see in themselves.
- Give them hope – French general Napoleon Bonaparte said, "*Leaders are dealers in hope.*" When you give people hope, you give them a future. Jeremiah 29:11 "***I know the plans I have for you... They are good and not bad... Give you hope and a future.***"

In discipleship the discipler must always be the initiator. Second Mile Leaders don't wait for people to connect with them, they make a hit list and connect with others. (Right now I want you

to make a list of six people you have influence with that you are going to begin the process of discipleship with)

Second Mile Leaders purposely connect with others with the intention of discipleship. We must take the first step with others and then make the effort to continue building relationships.

Second Mile Leaders see themselves as servants more than they see themselves as leaders. When we serve others, we add value to them.

Many people view leadership like success:

- Go as far and as fast as you can...
- Climb the ladder... (Step on the fingers of others if necessary)
- Achieve the highest possible position regardless of the cost to yourself or others...

Jesus said, “*He who wants to be greatest must become servant to all.*” Leadership isn’t how far we advance ourselves but how far we advance others.

All relationships either add to or subtract from a person’s life. So, one critical question: Are you making things better for the people who follow you?

Four guidelines for adding value to others:

- Truly value others... Effective leaders go beyond not harming others they intentionally help others. The care for others must be tangible. (Taking time to talk, visit, build relationships...) When we walk past people we are walking past our work.
- Make yourself more valuable to others... The more intentional we have been in growing personally, the more we have to

offer our followers. If we have nothing of value to add, then we can't add value. We can't give what you don't possess. Read a book, take a course, learn something to pass it on. Read a book on parenting or a struggle someone is facing so you can help them. For sure, stay in the word of God.

- **Know and relate to what others value...** One can only do this by listening to others stories, hopes and dreams. Inexperienced leaders are quick to attempt to lead before knowing anything about the people they intend to lead.
- **Learn what is valuable to them and then lead based on what you've learned...** This is manipulation if we don't care, but serving if we do care. If you desire to add value by serving others, you will become a better leader.

The true measure of leadership is influence. Do you have influence? Do people follow you and what you say and do?

Several factors that drive a leader's influence:

- Character... True leadership always begins with the inner person. People can sense the depth of a person's character.
- Relationships... Leadership is relational leverage. If you don't have relationships, you do not have the leverage to lead.
- Knowledge... What They Know – information is vital. You need a grasp of the facts to develop an accurate vision for the future.
- Experience... Do you know what you're talking about? The greater challenges you have overcome, the more likely followers will be willing to let you lead.

Here is a great leadership proverb: “*He who thinks he leads, but has no followers, is only taking a walk.*” If you can’t influence others, they won’t follow you. And if they won’t follow, you’re not a leader. That’s the Law of Influence. No matter what anybody else tells you, remember that leadership is influence — nothing more, nothing less.

So discipleship is about influence. We get to influence by serving. We serve best after we connect and know what the needs are.

To make a disciple, we must give our lives away. And in order for others to want what we are giving, we must have the right character, purpose and desire to influence others toward following Jesus.

SECOND MILE LEADERSHIP

SESSION 6B

THE SHEPHERDS HEART

As Second Mile Leaders, God is calling us into a ministry that will require us to be motivated by a force that compels us out of our comfort zone. It will be necessary for us to have the energy and capacity to go beyond what we experienced in the past.

Our natural tendency is to be selfish. That's mine. That's yours. (A baby thinks only of itself – It does not care when or who it inconveniences)

I would be lying if I said to you that I always wanted to do what is in the best interest of others. More often than not, I want to do what is in the best interest of myself.

If we are going to be Second Mile Leaders we must move beyond:

- Self-interest...
- Self-promotion...
- Self-preservation...

As Second Mile Leaders we must move into a mode of operation that is so counter-intuitive. We must learn to be motivated by something other than our own wisdom and greatness.

This motivation is one word. Compassion. This is what fuels our efforts. It is what makes us do great things for God. It is what causes us to make the sacrifices necessary to be what God is calling us to be.

A Second Mile Leader operating with compassion can do the unthinkable. Without it we are normal nominal Christians.

The word compassion is a compound word:

- Con – Possessing a quality...
- Passion - Great love and pity...

The Greek word for compassion used in the New Testament is “splagchnizomai” (Spla – gin – zoe- my) and this verb means “*To be moved from the bowels.*”

We get our model of compassion and our definition of what compassion looks like from our leader, Jesus Christ. As we look at his life tonight, I want us to put ourselves in his shoes.

I want us to think of our own life. I want us to be honest in self-reflection and see if we would make the same decisions as Jesus.

I want you to ask ourselves if we are truly ready to become a Second Mile Leader. I want us to come to terms with what is right and what is wrong in our hearts by the end of this session.

Matthew 14:10 – 13 *“So John was beheaded in the prison, 11and his head was brought on a tray and given to the girl, who took it to her mother. 12 Later, John’s disciples came for his body and buried it. Then they went and told Jesus what had happened. 13As soon as Jesus heard the news, he left in a boat to a remote area to be alone.”* John was the cousin of Jesus. John lost his life by decapitation. Jesus seems distraught about this. (Wouldn’t we all be?) He wanted to withdraw and have some “*me*” time. Seems fair, right?

The only problem was, people figured out where he was and where he was going. They still wanted something from him in spite of the fact

that he was grieving the loss of a relative.
(When I had surgery on my vocal chords and couldn't talk for six weeks a woman called and Susan told her I couldn't talk and her response was, "*I know, but he can listen.*")

Regardless of his grief the crowd was still clamoring:

- Teach us...
- Touch us...
- Fix us...

Matthew 14:13-16 ***"But the crowds heard where he was headed and followed on foot from many towns. 14 Jesus saw the huge crowd as he stepped from the boat, and he had compassion on them and healed their sick. 15 That evening the disciples came to him and said, "This is a remote place, and it's already getting late. Send the crowds away so they can***

go to the villages and buy food for themselves.”16 But Jesus said, “That isn’t necessary—you feed them.”

Jesus healed their sick even though his cousin had just been murdered. As a Second Mile Leader you are about to have hundreds of opportunities to live and love like Jesus. You have been where you are long enough and tonight I’m calling you UP to be a Second Mile Leader.

Here’s my question that you can answer in your mind tonight but the more accurate answers will be played out in real time: What attitude will you have? Will you have the attitude of Jesus or the attitude of the disciples?

See, Jesus had a shepherd’s heart that caused him to have an outward physical response of

serving when he didn't feel like it. The bible says he “*had compassion,*” and that he was “*moved with compassion.*” What does that mean?

Have you ever had a pain in your gut for someone that felt somewhat like your insides were being wrung out? I've prayed for people before and nearly been unable to stand due to the pain in my gut. I can only assume that it's similar to a contraction that a woman has while beginning the birthing process.

The disciples wanted to send the multitude away but Jesus said, “*Feed them.*” See, that's what Jesus always wants to do with you and me. He wants to feed people with our lives.

The problem is; we want to send people away. We don't want to care for them. Why? We don't have the same compassion that Jesus had.

Here's what it's going to take for us to be Second Mile Leaders, self-sacrifice motivated by compassion. Compassion is motivated by a spiritual condition. Matthew 9:35-36 ***“Jesus traveled through all the towns and villages of that area, teaching in the synagogues and announcing the Good News about the Kingdom. And he healed every kind of disease and illness. 36 When he saw the crowds, he had compassion on them because they were confused and helpless, like sheep without a shepherd.”***

What did Jesus see? He saw past their physical needs and saw what they needed spiritually. He saw that their lives were in shambles.

Jesus knew that sheep left to themselves would:

- Become the victims of their own stupidity...
- Eat the grass until the ground becomes sterile...
- Pollute the ground until it breeds parasites that will kill them...
- Drink polluted water until it becomes poison to their systems...

The flocking and following instinct of sheep is so strong that it caused the death of 400 sheep in 2006 in eastern Turkey. The sheep plunged to their death after one of the sheep tried to cross a fifteen-meter deep ravine, and the rest of the flock followed. Sound familiar?

You want to know what people are going to act like without someone in their lives to call them up and out of the mud and the muck? They are going to be victims of their own stupidity. They

are going to wallow in their filth. And without us, they will die!

That means instead of condemning them, yelling at them, ostracizing them, we are going to have to go where they are in order to save them.

Compassion propels us to action. Mark 6 :32-34

“So they left by boat for a quiet place, where they could be alone. 33 But many people recognized them and saw them leaving, and people from many towns ran ahead along the shore and got there ahead of them. 34 Jesus saw the huge crowd as he stepped from the boat, and he had compassion on them because they were like sheep without a shepherd. So he began teaching them many things.” Jesus had compassion! In other words, he didn't just shake his head and say that's bad! He got busy doing

something. Compassion has at its core a selflessness that moves us to do whatever it takes to touch and heal people:

- If we are not making time in our agenda to be inconvenienced by the pain and the situations of others, we are not operating in the spirit of compassion.
- When we have an attitude toward people that exclude them, rather than embrace them, we are most certainly not filled with compassion.
- If we're only serving where we enjoy serving, we are not being moved with compassion.
- If there's a task that's beneath us, we are not being moved by compassion.
- If we have not caught the vision for outreaches we are not being moved with compassion...

Do we get to mourn? Do we get to have “*ME*” time? Do you get to say no? Sure, if we don’t have compassion. Not if you realize what is at stake. Not if the heart of Jesus is in you. Not if you are a Second Mile Leader.

When we really get a glimpse of, and have had an impartation of the heart of God, we don’t have the luxury of sitting back and do nothing any more.

I want to ask us some soul-searching questions that will help us determine if we have the shepherd’s heart to be a Second Mile Leader:

- Are we willing to change our agenda to be a Second Mile Leader?
- Will we open our homes to be a Second Mile Leader?

- Will we answer our phones when we don't want to, in order to be a Second Mile Leader?
- Will we visit a hospital at an inconvenient time to be a Second Mile Leader?
- Will we pastor people when we need someone to pastor us, in order to be a Second Mile Leader?

If the answer to any of the above is no then we do not have a shepherds heart and therefore cannot be a Second Mile Leader.

God wants us to move with compassion even when it painful for us personally. If you are willing to become a Second Mile Leader I am going to pray for you tonight that the same shepherds heart that I have will be imparted to you.

**LAY HANDS ON EACH INDIVIDUAL
THAT IS WILLING TO GO FORWARD IN
THIS SECOND MILE JOURNEY.**

SECOND MILE LEADERSHIP

SESSION 7A

THE LAW OF SOLID GROUND

The BIG question here is, can you be trusted?
More importantly, can I trust you?

There is actually a currency in relationships. It is the capital that keeps the relational economy flowing. Trust is the reliance on the integrity, strength, ability or surety of a person.

I can say I trust this chair but I cannot demonstrate that trust without sitting in it. I can say I trust a person, but I cannot demonstrate that trust without putting myself in a place of reliance on that person.

So, think of it this way, when you've had a chair break on you multiple times, you stop sitting in

that kind of chair. When you and I hurt people enough, they stop relying on us. When we do not bear up under our responsibility our leaders stop calling on us because they cannot trust us.

As a Second Mile Leader, you must be trustworthy. **These are qualities that A Second Mile Leader must demonstrate to everyone they are serving:**

- **Keep confidences...** If people open up and share their hurts, their sins, their faults, will you push them away or will you embrace them while keeping their secret / confidence? When you commit to keeping a confidence but only tell one person, you have broken the trust. Once the trust is broken you are no longer a Second Mile Leader. When is it ok to share? When you are asking for help with a person in authority over you that you can trust to keep the same

confidence. If you share with someone else in the church, you have broken trust. One must do this with relationships or we will find ourselves out of leadership (influence).

- **Demonstrate genuine care...** We talked about this last week. Are you concerned enough about the person and their spiritual well being to stop talking and start listening? If you care, answer your phone. If you care pray for them like you said you would. If you care call them when they are missing in action? If you care go visit them when they are in the hospital. If you care make their needs a priority. If you care follow through. Second Mile Leaders ALWAYS do what they say they are going to do. Don't create an expectation of a meal, an appointment, prayer, follow up, phone call, etc and then fail to do it. If we drop the ball it communicates that we don't care. It may not

be true, but that's the feeling a missed opportunity creates.

As a Second Mile Leader can I trust you as a partner in ministry? When the Apostles laid their hands on the first Deacons they were saying “*These men are an extension of us.*” And that is what I am saying to you. Can I trust you to be an extension of Susan and me?

By making you a Second Mile Leader we are putting our credibility behind you, saying to people - these are trustworthy individuals that will pastor you like I pastor you. So my question to you is, [can I trust you?](#)

- [Can I trust you not to start your own ministry?](#) (To be under authority – The Centurion “*I am a man under authority*” - Campus Pastors agreement)

- Can I trust you with people who have a grievance with me or CT? (My experience with a man who called me to complain about my successor in Arkansas - Silence is consent)
- Can I trust you to help me build the Kingdom and not to ever do harm to it? (Some people can build but they eventually do more harm than good)
- Can I trust you to make decisions based on what you believe I want rather than how you think it should be? (My experience serving Bro. Granberry)

I the person who is ultimately responsible, not you. If you follow my lead, I take the heat. If you don't follow my lead, you are wrong even if you're right and you take the hit.

As a Second Mile Leader when dealing with grievances and frustrations, do not:

- Share with a peer...
- Share with someone you lead...
- Share with congregation...

This is poison and Jesus had strong words for such actions – ***“It would be better for you to have a millstone tied around your neck and cast into the sea than to offend one of these little ones.”*** Sometimes one comment is all it takes.

As a Second Mile Leader when dealing with grievances and frustrations, do the following:

- Ask questions for clarification...
- Offer improvements in the decision...
- Praise publicly / challenge privately...
- Be kind but candid... (I welcome feedback - You must welcome it as well)

Candid is uncomfortable but necessary Why?
Candor is important because it takes all the
“*nice*” out and cuts to the chase. It allows us the
ability to improve.

A lack of candor allows for distrust to grow.
Why? When a decision doesn’t sit well with us,
we question it. If we don’t ask for clarification,
we start questioning motives. If you don’t come
to request clarification from me, you start
wondering about my motives. Can you trust me?

If I don’t come to you, then I start wondering if
I can trust you to lead.

The reason we don’t have the conversation is
because it’s uncomfortable. Sometimes we think
it’s too small a matter to bring up. However,
without the conversation the air isn’t clear and

ultimately, offense and strongholds develop. If we give the devil a foothold he will climb into our minds.

People leave the church because they are unwilling to address conflict. Conflict avoidance ultimately becomes person avoidance.

This means, as a leader, I need you to be able to receive correction and constructive criticism. I open myself to you to explain myself whenever you need an explanation. In this relationship you must remember that I have information that you do not have and I may not be able to share it with you. In such a case you have to trust that I have the best interest of everyone at heart.

ASSIGNMENT: INVITE 6 PEOPLE OVER FOR A GAME NIGHT

SECOND MILE LEADERSHIP
SESSION 7B
LEADING WITH AN OPEN HEART

What you're about to be asked to do will undoubtedly produce wounds in you. Let me remind you of our vision: Disciple – Empower – Serve.

We want to reach everyone in our communities that no one else is reaching. I'm not opposed to people coming from other churches, but it is absolutely nowhere near my radar. I want the rejected, the unloved, the unwanted and the forgotten. That's who I want us to go after.

You know what all those people have in common? Hurt! Emotional pain. Do you know what those people are capable of causing in us? Hurt! Emotional pain.

Hurt people hurt people. I'm asking you to get on the front lines with me. And you're likely to suffer if you do.

A Second Mile Leader is much like an Emergency Medical Technician (EMT):

- An EMT is a person who runs toward situations that everyone else is running from... When everyone else leaves and abandons the injured, an EMT must find a way to get to them while doing their best not to become a patient themselves. This is exactly what a Second Mile Leader does.
- An EMT wears personal protective equipment... PPE is first and foremost. What is the point in saving others while creating casualties? Second Mile Leaders protect themselves with prayer, the Word, the armor of God and close personal

relationships with other Second Mile Leaders. (Iron sharpens iron)

- An EMT always asks *“Is the scene safe”* before proceeding... Second Mile Leaders don't become impatient but move forward deliberately. We don't want to die in the process of saving others. So we must use precautions. ***“If you see your brother overtaken in a fault, ye which are spiritual restore him considering yourself, lest ye also be tempted.”***

The spiritual scene won't ever be completely safe. But, we can protect ourselves by forgiving those who wrong do us wrong. [Matthew 18:21-35](#) ***“Then Peter came to Jesus and asked, “Lord, how many times shall I forgive my brother when he sins against me? Up to seven times?” 22 Jesus answered, “I tell you, not seven times, but seventy-seven times. 23***

"Therefore, the kingdom of heaven is like a king who wanted to settle accounts with his servants. 24 As he began the settlement, a man who owed him ten thousand talents was brought to him. 25 Since he was not able to pay, the master ordered that he and his wife and his children and all that he had be sold to repay the debt. 26 "The servant fell on his knees before him. 'Be patient with me,' he begged, 'and I will pay back everything.' 27 The servant's master took pity on him, canceled the debt and let him go. 28 "But when that servant went out, he found one of his fellow servants who owed him a hundred denarii. He grabbed him and began to choke him. 'Pay back what you owe me!' he demanded. 29 "His fellow servant fell to his knees and begged him, 'Be patient with me, and I will pay you back.' 30 "But he refused. Instead, he went off and had the man thrown

into prison until he could pay the debt. 31 When the other servants saw what had happened, they were greatly distressed and went and told their master everything that had happened. 32 "Then the master called the servant in. 'You wicked servant,' he said, 'I canceled all that debt of yours because you begged me to. 33 Shouldn't you have had mercy on your fellow servant just as I had on you?' 34 In anger his master turned him over to the jailers to be tortured, until he should pay back all he owed. 35 "This is how my heavenly Father will treat each of you unless you forgive your brother from your heart."

Forgiveness plays one of the highest roles in the Kingdom. Jesus makes it clear that we are the ones forgiven much from the master, so we had better forgive the small debts against us. We

have to be able to “*let it go.*” The only person that is being bothered, I assure you, is YOU.

Do we want to win the argument or win the person?

Don't return evil for evil. Don't out people on social media. Don't run them down to others. (Friend of mine recently won a \$2.1 million dollar liable lawsuit – First ever tried based on social media)

The number one reason people leave a church is unresolved conflict. Our tendency is to ignore (Sideswipe) conflict hoping it will just go away. We sweep it under the rug, but it grows inside us as a cancer and ultimately will take us out of the relationship.

Second Mile Leaders confront disagreements and conflict with an open heart. We handle situations as if we are dealing with our own mother. (My mom's comments about retiring)

Allow people to have a path back while maintaining their dignity. If you don't allow people to ask forgiveness and return to you in relationship, you will not be able to lead. (Pastor who wanted to dismiss a deacon despite the fact the man had already resigned)

The goal of a Second Mile Leader is to restore people rather than have to be right. Sometimes we can't be right and restore at the same time. ,

As a leader we must always give the benefit of the doubt.

We tend to judge ourselves by our motives, but others by their actions. We don't like to give people the benefit of the doubt. People say things that are mean. And, even though they are characterized by being kind, we throw them away over one act. We don't chalk it up to a bad day or a misunderstanding we judge them to have an ulterior motive.

In the American court system, we are innocent until proven guilty. In the church, we are guilty until proven innocent. Second Mile Leaders always give others the benefit of the doubt.

Second Mile Leaders trade their rights for their responsibilities. Romans 14:20-21 ***“Don't tear apart the work of God over what you eat. Remember, all foods are acceptable, but it is wrong to eat something if it makes another person stumble. 21 It is better not to eat meat***

or drink wine or do anything else if it might cause another believer to stumble.” 1 John 2:9-10 “Anyone who claims to be in the light but hates his brother is still in the darkness. 10 Whoever loves his brother lives in the light, and there is nothing in him to make him stumble. 11 But whoever hates his brother is in the darkness and walks around in the darkness; he does not know where he is going, because the darkness has blinded him.”

Second Mile Leaders:

- Walk in forgiveness...
- Live with an open heart...
- Give the benefit of the doubt...
- Trade their rights for their responsibilities...

SECOND MILE LEADERSHIP

SESSION 8A

ARE YOU F.A.T.

You never ever-ever ask a woman if she's pregnant. Even if she is in labor, you don't ask if she's pregnant. You never ever-ever say it even if you think it. (Pastor who did this in a prayer line – If your wife asks if an outfit makes her look fat the answer is NOOOOOOO - Bumper sticker I saw in Springfield)

You just never talk about a woman's weight.

But, today, I'm going to ask every single one of you - men and women - if you are FAT. Ask your neighbor if you look FAT?

I'm not talking about being overweight. I'm not talking about losing a few. I'm talking about

three critical elements that are absolutely necessary to be a Second Mile Leader:

- Faithful...
- Available...
- Teachable...

If we honestly evaluated ourselves could we truly conclude that we are faithful, available and teachable? If we have pause in any of these areas we must move quickly to fix what is lacking, if we intend to be a Second Mile Leader.

All three of these elements are critical to have - we can't lead without them. (My illustration in Malvern on excuses)

Honestly, that is how some people who consider themselves a leader approach their leadership in

the church and then they are offended when they are not given certain responsibilities.

Just like you have to have air to breath or you won't survive, without these traits you won't survive as a leader. If you do not possess these qualities eventually, someone in authority must replace you over you. Or, you will simply fade into the background because you have lost your influence.

Sadly many people who would are in a place of leadership fail at one or more of these qualities and do not have enough integrity to step up, or step out of the position they have been asked to fulfill. When this happens, they place the supervisor in the dubious position of having to call the individual into question or set them down. Oftentimes the person who has not fulfilled their responsibilities becomes offended

and plays the part of a martyr. When this occurs they are proving the leader was right to make the decision to pull the leadership plug on the individual.

VERY IMPORTANT: When the leadership must deal with an individual and other Second Mile Leaders take their side:

- Agreeing with a disciplined leader is not helping the individual who is being dealt with... (They learn nothing – Dealing with a staff member whose family took his side)
- Agreeing with a disciplined leader is a violation of the faithfulness principle of leadership...
- When a Second Mile Leader comes into agreement with a disciplined leader they themselves must be disciplined...

- Second Mile Leaders hold each other accountable... (We must hang together or we will hang separately)

Ezekiel 22:30 (NKJV) “*So I sought for a man among them who would make a wall, and stand in the gap before Me on behalf of the land, that I should not destroy it; but I found no one.*” Whenever God has a job to do and a gap to be filled, he always starts by choosing and calling an individual. While men use methods, God's methods are men and women.

Lets look at these in depth.

Are you faithful?

In 2 Timothy 2:2, Paul admonished Timothy, ***"The things that you have heard from me among many witnesses, commit these to faithful men who will be able to teach others***

also.” Notice, Paul doesn’t tell Timothy to commit his teachings to talented men, or to influential men, or to wealthy men. Paul doesn’t say – “*Hey Timothy - find the man who can really wow people. Timothy - find the people who are connected in the city - The movers and shakers. Hey Timothy - find the people who give more than anyone else in your church - that’s who you need to entrust this to.*”

Nope! He said “*Invest into faithful people. Invest in people that are reliable. Invest in people who commit and follow through. Invest in people of character and integrity*”.

You were invited into this Second Mile Leadership training because I believe you can pass the FAT test! You are the people I want to invest my life into, because I believe you can be counted on to carry the vision forward. [Proverbs](#)

20:6 “Many claim to have unfailing love, but a faithful person who can find?”

The word faithful means:

- Strict or thorough in the performance of duty, not halfway.
- True to one's word, promises, vows, etc...
- Steady in allegiance or affection; loyal; constant...
- Reliable, trusted, or to be believed...

1 Samuel 2:35 (NLT) “Then I will raise up a faithful priest who will serve me and do what I desire. I will establish his family, and they will be priests to my anointed kings forever.”

God said the kind of priest he wanted would be:

- Faithful... What was the key to this priest being anointed forever? Faithfulness! Will you be Faithful to the ministry with which

you are about to be entrusted? Will you own it as though it is your own? Will you make sure it is taken care of if you're out of town? Will you do it even when you don't feel like it, or you want to move to another ministry? Will you stay at your post of duty until you have raised up your own replacement? Will you raise up a faithful replacement?

- [Established...](#) Established means to be made permanent. Neither God nor I are looking for flashes in a pan! People who come to leadership and make a BIG splash and then quickly fade are worse for the organization than not having a leader to begin with! Second Mile Leaders are established leaders.
- [Generational...](#) Notice, the Scripture mentions that faithful leaders establish a family line of anointed leaders! I believe in generational anointing. Susan and I have been blessed with faithful parents – We have

had the opportunity to do what our parents could never have dreamed possible! Our children will no doubt go far past what we will be able to do! Our grandchildren will do more than our children! The faithfulness or unfaithfulness we demonstrate will establish a generational anointing of success or a generational pattern of failure!

[1 Corinthians 4:2](#) (NLT) ***“Now, a person who is put in charge as a manager must be faithful.”***
A Second Mile Leader [MUST](#) be faithful.

Available...

[1 Samuel 3:10](#) (NLT) ***“And the LORD came and called as before, “Samuel! Samuel!” And Samuel replied, “Speak, your servant is listening.”*** [Isaiah 6:8](#) (NLT) ***“Then I heard the Lord asking, “Whom should I send as a***

messenger to this people? Who will go for us?"
I said, "Here I am. Send me."

No matter how gifted they are little can be done with someone who is already working eighteen hours a day and can't even find time for their family, or for the Lord. If a person is unwilling or unable to alter their priorities or adjust their schedule; they cannot be a Second Mile Leader.

In order to lead in God's Kingdom, you and I must make the things of God a priority in our lives. We have to adjust our schedule. We have to give up some leisure. (Maybe some trips - Maybe some hunting - Maybe some "me" time)

It is very disheartening when the leader can clearly see great Kingdom potential in certain people, yet it becomes impossible to get them to commit. They say they're good... They say they

are going to be there to help you... They say they are going to follow through... But when push comes to shove, they just aren't there!

Second Mile Leaders put themselves out there for whatever, wherever, whenever.

There are many people who have the talent and they have the character, but they simply won't make themselves available. Gifted people who are not available are inconsequential to the Kingdom of God! (I have many examples of this over the years – A family member who had more gifts than almost anyone I know but their lack of availability caused me to waste their life - Abraham dragging donkeys up the hill)

One of the most important qualities of a Second Mile Leader is to be available and show up.

If you want to be a Second Mile Leader just show up, and keep showing up! Why? I'm not willing to invest training and time in a person who can't prove they are faithful and available. All too often I have experienced the pain of training someone to do some complex task and then they don't show up! I have learned to invest in people who are available and faithful to show up to perform menial tasks!

Sometimes people wonder why it seems that individuals who are less qualified get to lead in a certain area. Why do they get the microphone? Why do they seem to be the right hand of the leader? Why do they always seem to land in the honey hole? Why do they have the ear of the leader? Probably because they are available and faithful! **Leaders prefer availability and faithfulness over gifts and talent!**

Some people say, “*Make a spot for me and I’ll show up!*” I say, “*Show up, and your availability and faithfulness will make a spot for you!*”

Leaders would rather train and correct a faithful and available person than to try to find a way to use a super-talented one! Why? Because leaders know that superstars are normally in it for themselves, not for the vision.

In the beginning, high performers may have been the least qualified person to lead or talk. But they kept showing up and before you know it, they earned the trust and respect of the leader, and acquired the skills necessary to do the job effectively.

If you are unavailable the organization will move past you and you will find yourself on the

outside looking in. People move on without you. Your leadership fades and erodes and you find yourself without a place to lead.

Make yourself available.

Teachable...

Leaders and followers must be teachable. It should be understood that we don't know all we need to know. We are learning. We are lifetime learners.

The truth is, we can learn something from anyone and everyone. Any man or woman can be your teacher so long as you have a humble heart.

God used the disciples not only because they were faithful and available, but also because they were teachable.

Mark Twain once said, *"Never undertake to instruct a pig to sing. You'll only frustrate yourself and annoy the pig."*

Second Mile Leaders avoid the pitfall of becoming a know-it-all.

Know-it-alls:

- Do not see the need to be taught...
- They always have an excuse for not showing up to be trained...
- They believe they are always the smartest person in the room...
- They are annoying to everyone else and are the only one who don't know it...

Paul told Timothy that know-it-alls are, “***Ever learning, and never able to come to the knowledge of the truth.***”

If we think we are going to be able to lead others, we must be willing to receive instruction! [Hebrews 5:12](#) (NKJV) “***For though by this time you ought to be teachers, you need someone to teach you again the first principles of the oracles of God; and you have come to need milk and not solid food.***”

The teachable test includes:

- Accepting correction willingly...
- Seeking feedback from various sources...
- Seeing correction as an opportunity rather than a threat...
- Constantly looking for better methods to do things...
- Being a lifetime learner...

If we are not teachable then we are doomed to stay stuck exactly where we are. God and I love you too much to leave you like you are.

A Second Mile Leader knows what they don't know.

The more I learn, the more I realize I have to learn. I have a vision, but God has given me a lot of wisdom from people that are buying into the vision. Each person on the team has some insight that each of us can learn and benefit from.

As a leader I must guard against being threatened by the wisdom of others, rather looking at it as an opportunity to grow and become more effective.

Let me ask you, do you make it difficult for your leader to correct you? [Hebrews 13:17](#) (NLT) *“Obey your spiritual leaders, and do what they say. Their work is to watch over your souls, and they are accountable to God. Give them reason to do this with joy and not with sorrow. That would certainly not be for your benefit.”*

[Second Mile Leaders](#) give permission to those who are leading them to say:

- [What](#) they want to...
- [When](#) they want to...
- [How](#) they want to...

... and we give up the right to be [offended](#).

Being teachable means we have a spirit of humility and a spirit that is eager to grow.

Matthew 23:12 *“For whoever exalts himself will be humbled, and whoever humbles himself will be exalted.”*

SECOND MILE LEADERSHIP

SESSION 8B

QUALIFICATIONS

In this final lesson we are going to talk about the qualifications and expectations of a Second Mile Leader. **We expect you to:**

- Host a life group...
- Assist a life group leader...
- Be a home opener for a life group...
- Be a section pastor...

Second Mile Leadership training concludes tonight. Pastor Roy will train those of you who want to sign up as a Second Mile Leader to do a life group. Sherry Jones will train those of you who are willing to be a section pastor. (Give date and time)

Tonight those of us who are going to be a Second Mile Leader will enter into a covenant with CT Church and with one another. **The Second Mile Leadership Covenant will be one of character and service: 1 Timothy 4:12 “*Set an example for the believers in speech, in conduct, in love, in faith and in purity.*”**

SPEECH

Second Mile Leaders only speak words that build others up. As a leader we refrain from speaking negatively over others and their lives. We also refuse to speak negative words about this church, its leaders, or our fellow Second Mile Leaders. If we have issues with things that happen in the course of relationships or with the operation of ministries, we agree to bring those matters to the leaders privately, requesting assistance in providing remedy for the situation.

As a Second Mile Leader I agree to conduct my life so as not to be a stumbling block for anyone through the words I say or the actions I take. I agree to:

- Bridle my tongue...
- Refrain from the use of alcohol...
- Refrain from the use of illegal drugs...
- Refrain from the use of tobacco...

CONDUCT

As a leader in this body:

- I commit to behave in such a manner as to influence people toward Christ, not away from Him or His church...
- I will seek to live a life that is worthy of imitation...
- I will conduct myself in such a way, that if people follow in my footsteps, they will be led straight to Jesus...

As a leader, we bear responsibility for those around us. Because of that we must serve without limits to be as large an influence as possible for the people around us to come to know Christ and to grow in Him.

We must be committed to serving this body of believers. Other than unplanned true emergencies, or when I am required to work on my first job, I will seek to actively be engaged in serving and leading the ministry activities of the church.

A Second Mile Leader knows that no area of service is beneath them. They will serve wherever, whenever and do whatever is needed in order to provide an environment where others can experience the love and power of Jesus Christ.

Second Mile Leaders serve with:

- **Biblical integrity...** (A good name is to be desired above great riches)
- **Ridiculous stewardship...** (Be a tither – We don't walk with thieves)
- **Absolute dependability...** (No excuses – Be where you are supposed to be when you are supposed to be there – Be prepared – Being on time is being late)
- **Selfless teamwork...** (Be mindful of the rest of the team – Take the highest road)
- **Extreme excellence...** (Treat your ministry as if it is the most important thing you are ever going to do – Because it is – Laying up treasure where moth and rust don't corrupt and where thieves do not break through and steal)
- **Radical respect...** (Always prefer others ahead of yourself)

LOVE

Second Mile Leaders commit to exhibiting the characteristics of 1 Corinthians 13 through our lives and ministries: How do we to know whether we are walking in love?

- Love is patient with people...
- Love is kind and good... (Showing and showering favors)
- Love does not allow for envy or jealousy...
- Love does not brag or seek recognition from others...
- Love does not feel or act better than others...
- Love is not rude...
- Love is not touchy or quick tempered...
- Love does not keep record of wrongs done...
- Love allows for no gloating over the wrongdoing or misfortune of others...
- Love is satisfied only with truth...

- Love is sturdy under heavy responsibility and is willing to cover for weaker Christians...
- Love chooses to trust...
- Love believes the best in all situations...
- Love never loses hope...
- Love remains faithful in spite of repeated attacks...
- Love never quits...
- Love is perfect and complete...
- Love displays maturity rather than immaturity...
- Love handles others as if it were handling God...

We will seek out those who are lonely, hurt, wounded and broken and pour ourselves into them. (This is time consuming and heart wrenching)

Leaders believe the best about our fellow leaders. We choose to cover them with support and prayer rather than exposing their weaknesses and failures. The life of a leader must be a demonstration of the love of God by the way we love our brothers and sisters in Christ. [Second Mile Leaders do not take the high road when offended: We take the highest road.](#)

There will be times when we must lovingly confront others about their attitudes and behaviors. When this is necessary we are to do so from a motivation that seeks their best interest and strengthening their relationship with God. When this becomes necessary, we must do this in a manner that deals with the situation with as much privacy and dignity as possible. This will have the propensity to draw them toward, not push them away from Christ.

FAITH

Second Mile Leaders commit to being a person who is in the word and prayer daily. ***“Faith comes by hearing... Hearing from the Word of God.”*** If you do not have a set time to pray and read your Word every day – You don’t have a prayer life. If you don’t have a prayer life you can’t be a Second Mile Leader. You can’t give what you don’t have.

As a leader on this team and in this body, others will need me to be ready at a moment's notice to pray for and encourage them.

Second Mile Leaders know that it is only out of an overflow of the presence of God in our lives that we are able be of any assistance to those who need us.

We realize that people will need to lean on us as a source of strength and hope and it is imperative that our faith is strong enough to support them and us. We must make sure our relationship with God is fresh so we can lift the faith of others.

PURITY

As people who cast a shadow of influence over those we lead, Second Mile Leaders realize that our personal conduct and spiritual condition bears influence over those we lead. Because of that we must commit to keep our minds, eyes, and body pure from this world. According to the book of James, we must walk in an accountable relationship with God and others. All Second Mile Leaders must have an accountability partner. James 5:16 (LB) *“Admit your faults to one another and pray for each other so that you may be healed. The earnest prayer of a*

righteous man has great power and wonderful results.”

Those who want to be effective leaders maintain an accountable relationship with a peer. We also willingly allow our leaders to check with our accountability partners to assure we have been open, honest and transparent with them regarding issues in our lives.

SHEPHERDING DUTIES

As a Second Mile Leader you are needed each week to connect with the people in your section and to assist in creating a positive experience for guests, from the parking lot, to connecting them to a small group, and then getting them engaged in serving.

Second Mile Leaders do not become offended when:

- The parking lot fills up we are asked to move our cars...
- We are asked to show up early or stay late and clean toilets and stack chairs...
- The room fills up, and we are asked to give up our seats...
- We move into multiple services and are asked ask to attend a new service at a time we don't prefer...
- We are asked to lead the way making a financial sacrifice...

We may be asking you to serve:

- On the security team...
- On the parking lot...
- As an usher or greeter...
- As a nursery or children's worker...
- As a volunteer with the youth group...

As a Second Mile Leader we do not have the luxury of saying no to serve where we are needed, or to cop a bad attitude because we don't want to serve.

TEAM LEADERSHIP

Each Second Mile Leader is expected to either take a lead role, or an apprentice role with a leader of an area of ministry.

We should always be staffing for growth. In order to double in size, we need twice the leaders and volunteers that we currently have. You should always be looking for your replacement in your ministry position. **Second Mile Leaders** always lead and mentor continuously and simultaneously.

CORE BELIEFS

In order to be a Second Mile Leader, you must adhere to, practice and speak the same doctrinal beliefs of CT Church. (HAND OUT DOCTRINAL BELIEFS)

CONTRIBUTION

Give

You must tithe to be in leadership. We sincerely believe the tithe is set apart unto God and is accursed if we spend it on ourselves. To do so, is to bring a curse on the house just like Akin's family. This will not be allowed for leaders.

Your tithe must be clearly marked where it can be tracked. Anonymous giving will not work for leaders.

Attend

Each of you are expected to attend faithfully not regularly. We should be here early and plan to stay late following the services. Our duty is to

serve and connect people and we cannot do this without showing up.

Serve

Since you are now expected to be leaders, serving is mandatory.

As a Second Mile Leader you will now be expected to serve at:

- Church services...
- Life groups...
- Food fairs...
- Health fairs...
- Training opportunities...

Second Mile Leaders must always be aware of the fact that a church will never rise above its leadership!

As a Second Mile Leader you can expect:

- Difficulty...

- [Resistance...](#)
- [Offenses...](#)

When you step into leadership you are engaging in serious spiritual warfare. Your position in the battle just changed from the mess hall to the front line. You are moving from a soldier in the army of God to a commander in the army of God.

This is way more serious than any of us ever think. You and your family are about to become prime targets for the enemy. You will be blindsided and you will be tempted to forget why you are where you are and who your source is. This is a spiritual battle in which the leaders are the prime target of the enemy.

Keep your guard up. Keep yourself in accountable in all of your relationships. Keep

yourself in a place of constant prayer and prayer covering.

There will be times when it will be difficult to keep going. You simply cannot quit. ***“There is no discharge in the army of God.”***

“A good soldier is willing to endure affliction.”

“He who puts his hand to the plough and looks back is not fit for the Kingdom of God.”

“If any man will come after me let him deny himself, take up his cross and follow me.”

As Second Mile Leaders far too many people are counting on us for us to have the luxury of failure. You will build deep relationships with people - to remove yourself quickly from those relationships will be to destroy their very souls.

God is not going to call you one day and then undo that decision the next day. Don't take the easy way out. Take the difficult path through.

Today I am asking you to make a one-year commitment to your position and leadership as a Second Mile Leader.

If and when you decide to move from your position of leadership, it is your responsibility to find and train your own replacement. You can't just walk away and leave an area uncovered. Your replacement must be able to do what you do better than you can do it. How do we accomplish the passing of the baton of responsibility?

- I do the work and you watch me...
- You help me do the work...
- You do the work and I watch you...

- You do the work and I hold you accountable...

MY 2ND MILE LEADERSHIP COVENANT

I recognize the importance of having spiritual, moral, and ethical accountability. I will seek and and receive coaching, correction and spiritual discipline in my life.

Should I violate any of these covenants, I welcome loving correction in my life. I will humbly and sincerely submit to correction and will seek to remedy any situation or offense for which I am responsible.

If, in the future I fail to submit to direction of leadership or Godly, loving, coaching and correction, I will submit a quiet resignation from my post of duty. I commit to NEVER bring a reproach upon the leadership of CT Church or my fellow Second Mile Leaders.